

HOUSE No. 1827

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Kathleen R. LaNatra

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to police reports involving railroad fatalities.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Kathleen R. LaNatra</i>	<i>12th Plymouth</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>
<i>Michelle L. Badger</i>	<i>1st Plymouth</i>	<i>2/23/2025</i>
<i>Michael D. Brady</i>	<i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>2/6/2025</i>
<i>Nick Collins</i>	<i>First Suffolk</i>	<i>1/26/2026</i>

HOUSE No. 1827

By Representative LaNatra of Kingston, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1827) of Kathleen R. LaNatra, Michelle L. Badger and Michael D. Brady for legislation to further regulate police reports involving railroad fatalities. The Judiciary.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to police reports involving railroad fatalities.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 160 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following section:-

2 Section 253. (a) Any police report involving a railroad fatality and all communications
3 between police officers and railroad crew members involved in such fatality shall not be made
4 public and shall be maintained by the police department that responds to such fatality in a
5 manner that shall ensure confidentiality; provided, however, that all such reports shall be
6 accessible at all reasonable times, upon written request, to (i) the host railroad, (ii) the railroad of
7 employ of any employee mentioned in such reports and (iii) any other person authorized by
8 judicial order to obtain such information if access to such report is necessary in the performance
9 of their duties; and provided further, that all such reports shall be accessible at all reasonable
10 times, upon written or electronic mail request to law enforcement officers, district attorneys or
11 assistant district attorneys.

12 (b) Communications between police officers and railroad employees concerning any
13 railroad fatality incident may be shared with any person listed in subsection (a) if such access is
14 necessary to the performance of their duties.

15 (c) A violation of this section shall be punished by imprisonment for not more than 1 year
16 or by a fine of not more than \$10,000, or both.